DAMNED MOON — Game Bible v0.1

Excel/VBA Choose-Your-Own-Adventure RPG Tone: Gritty / Grounded Horror Setting: 1960, rural America

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THE PREMISE

A young Black man passing through the wrong stretch of road on the wrong night comes out the other side of something he can't explain — bloody, unhurt, and alone. The town ahead of him is the only option. It has its own history with what lives in those woods. Getting in is the easy part.

PLAYER CHARACTER

Marcus Grave

- Age: 25
- Black male, passing through — not local, not welcome, not leaving until he gets answers
- Was running contraband with his friend Curtis for a local thug named Darnell when the attack happened
- Woke up in a field outside Wroughtwood with torn, bloody clothes and no wounds
- Infected with lycanthropy — does not fully understand this yet
- May carry Curtis's cracked watch as a persistent inventory item — only if `CURTIS_WATCH_FOUND` flag is set (Scene 001, Choice A)

KEY CHARACTERS

Curtis

- Marcus's friend and partner on the job
- **Missing at game start**
- **Truth (hidden until late game):** Curtis is the one who attacked Marcus. He was infected first — possibly deliberately — and is now running with the alpha's pack
- The gut punch reveal: Marcus spends the whole game looking for his friend. His friend is the monster.
- His jacket is found high in a tree near the attack site — placed deliberately, not lost
- His mother's watch is found near Marcus — also placed. Curtis knew what he'd done.

Darnell

- The local thug who hired Marcus and Curtis to run the contraband
- Separate storyline — eventually shows up in Wroughtwood threatening Marcus
- Doesn't know about the lycanthropy, just knows his delivery is late and his runner is missing
- Represents the world Marcus came from catching up to him
- The package is still in Marcus's wrecked car — leverage Marcus didn't ask for. **Contents: drugs (narcotics).** Darnell's product.
- **Car Timer Mechanic:** The wrecked car has a retrieval window. Return too early — the pack may still be in the area, high risk encounter. Wait too long — local teens (ages 16-18) find the car and take the package. Marcus must recover it before Darnell arrives.
- **Teen Recovery Quest:** If TEENS_HAVE_PACKAGE is set, Marcus can interact with the teens across multiple encounters, building rapport and learning their personalities. Two recovery paths:
  - **Rapport Path:** Earn their trust over time — trade favors, cover for them, treat them like people. They hand it back or lead Marcus to it willingly. Slower. Keeps Marcus's humanity intact. May turn teens into minor recurring allies with town knowledge.
  - **Strength Path:** Use emerging lycanthropy — enhanced presence, physical intimidation, something in the eyes that makes people step back. Fast. Clean. Effective. Stat cost: COMPOSURE -1, INSTINCT +1. The teens won't talk about it openly but the fear spreads. Wroughtwood notices something is different about the stranger. And Marcus notices he didn't hesitate.
  - Flag: PACKAGE_SECURED only available within the window. If window is missed: PACKAGE_LOST set, TEENS_HAVE_PACKAGE set.

Harlan Doss

- Old man who walks the field perimeter every morning at dawn
- **True Identity:** Dominion agent — the same organization from *Containment Procedure* (set ~60 years later)
- Has been in Wroughtwood tracking the source of the werewolf anomalies
- Not hostile to Marcus — but his agenda is not Marcus's survival
- **Secret Ending:** "CONTAINED" — unlocked when player uncovers Harlan's true identity and follows his thread to its end
- Easter egg connecting Damned Moon to Containment Procedure as shared universe

Marie Veau

- *Homage to Marie Laveau, Voodoo Queen of New Orleans*
- African American hoodoo practitioner
- **Ageless** — her age is genuinely unclear and intentionally so
- **Predates Wroughtwood itself** — was on this land before the town, before the settlers, possibly before the natives were driven off
- Has her own undisclosed reasons for remaining in Wroughtwood
- Lives in the swamp on the edge of Wroughtwood — willow trees, soft dark ground, a threshold most town people have spent their whole lives not crossing
- Her home requires Marcus to actively choose to go there — it is not on the way to anything
- **Housing:** One of two options for Marcus — requires earning her trust first
- Suspects immediately that Marcus is infected but tests him rather than stating it
- Helping Marcus is not charity — it is calculation. The price is never named upfront.
- Rooted in African American hoodoo tradition but her practice and knowledge predates and supersedes any single tradition

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THE WORLD

Wroughtwood

- Remote, isolated, rural American town — 1960
- Lives entirely outside modern life — no television, limited electricity, insular
- Suspicious of outsiders by nature, actively hostile to Black outsiders in the context of 1960 America
- **Has its own history with lycanthropy** — this is not the first time. The town has a memory of it, rules around it, and people who know what signs to look for
- Built on land sacred to a Native tribe — the tribe was killed and driven off by the settlers
- The sacred land's history is alive in the soil. The wooden boundary markers are still out there.

The Land

- The field where Marcus wakes is on the edge of what was once considered a sacred threshold
- The tree line to the north is where the attacks happen — and where the pack moves
- Wroughtwood was built *over* something and that something is connected to why the lycanthropy keeps returning here

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STORYLINE THREADS

Thread	Status	Notes
The Curse	Main	What happened to Marcus, what he's becoming
Curtis	Main	Find the friend — gut punch reveal late game
Darnell	Secondary	Pressure from outside, arrives in Wroughtwood eventually
The Pack / Alpha	Main	Who leads the wolves. What they want.
Marie Veau	Secondary / Key	Trust mechanic — unlocks housing and deeper lore
Harlan / Dominion	Hidden	Easter egg thread — leads to CONTAINED ending
The Land	Background / Lore	Native history, boundary markers, why Wroughtwood keeps producing this

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HOUSING OPTIONS

Option	How Unlocked	Risk	Benefit
Local Inn	Default — available immediately	Public. Town watches who comes and goes. Darnell can find Marcus easily.	Cheap. Central. Easier to gather information. Provides odd jobs / quests for Marcus to earn money. **Day 3 trigger:** Darnell calls the inn looking for Marcus — hard pressure point regardless of what else is happening.
Marie Veau's House	Requires trust — earned through multiple interactions	Isolated. Marie has her own agenda.	Hidden from Darnell. Access to hoodoo knowledge and lycanthropy lore.

ENDINGS (Known So Far)

Ending	Trigger
CONTAINED	Uncover Harlan Doss's true identity and follow the Dominion thread
TBD	—

CORE STATS

Stat	Range	Tracks	High Means	Low Means
HEALTH	0–100	Physical wellbeing	Alive, capable	Dead — game over
RAGE	0–100	Wolf aggression building	Transformation risk, unlocks strength options	Calm, more human choices available
HUNGER	0–100	The wolf's need to feed	Forced consumption events, reduced HUMANITY	Satisfied — wolf quiet for now
HUMANITY	0–100	How much of Marcus remains	Full control, town trusts him more, rapport easier	Feral drift — loses choices, wolf decides

Base Starting Stats

Stat	Starting Value	Reasoning
HEALTH	85	Physically unharmed but the night was hard on the body
RAGE	15	The wolf is new and quiet — Marcus doesn't feel it yet
HUNGER	40	One night's worth of the wolf feeding — the need is already building
HUMANITY	90	Still fully himself — the man who woke up is still Marcus Grave

Scene 001 Choice Modifiers

Choice	Effect	Reasoning
A — Call for Curtis	HUMANITY +5, RAGE +5	Love for his friend steadies him — but the silence makes something in him angry
B — Follow the drag trail	HUNGER -10, RAGE +10	Seeing what he did satisfies something he doesn't want to name — and disturbs him deeply
C — Search for the car	HEALTH +5, HUMANITY -5	Practical thinking keeps him grounded physically — but treating Curtis as secondary costs him
D — Try to remember	HUMANITY +5, HUNGER +5	Sitting with himself is human — but the memory stirs the wolf's appetite
E — Stay and watch	RAGE -10, HUNGER +10	Patience and stillness calm the wolf — but the hunger grows in the quiet

Stat Interactions

- **RAGE** fills faster at night, during confrontation, and when HUNGER is high
- **HUNGER** climbs each in-game day — must be managed or it forces RAGE up
- **HUMANITY** drains when Marcus uses wolf abilities, acts on instinct, or loses control — recovers slowly through human connection (Marie, inn rapport, teen relationships)
- **HEALTH** is the only stat that doesn't directly connect to the wolf — but low HEALTH at nightfall increases transformation risk
- Reaching **RAGE 100** triggers involuntary transformation — Marcus blacks out, a night scene plays, he wakes somewhere else with consequences
- Reaching **HUMANITY 0** is a bad ending — Marcus doesn't die, he just stops being Marcus

PERSISTENT FLAGS

Flag	Set When
CURTIS_WATCH_FOUND	Scene 001, Choice A
DEER_CARCASS_SEEN	Scene 001, Choice B
PACKAGE_SECURED	Scene 001, Choice C (within retrieval window)
MEMORY_01_UNLOCKED	Scene 001, Choice D
SHAPE_WITNESSED	Scene 001, Choice E
HARLAN_FIRST_IMPRESSION	All Scene 001 paths — value set by arrival state
PACKAGE_LOST	Car retrieval window missed
TEENS_HAVE_PACKAGE	Car retrieval window missed
TRUST_MARIE	Increments through Marie Veau interactions
DOMINION_THREAD	Triggered when player begins uncovering Harlan's identity

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SCENE MAP (In Progress)

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SCENE 001 — THE FIELD (Opening)
    ├── 002A — No Answer (called for Curtis)
    ├── 002B — The Tree Line
    ├── 002C — The Package
    ├── 002D — Memory Fragment 01
    └── 002E — The Watching
          ↓ (all paths)
SCENE 003 — HARLAN (field meeting, all paths)
          ↓
SCENE 004 — WROUGHTWOOD (first entry)
          ↓
    ├── Inn thread
    └── Marie Veau thread (trust required)
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